



Welcome to the OSGeo:UK Newsletter

Hello and welcome to the OSGeo:UK newsletter in which we share updates and information every couple of months about the OSGeo:UK local chapter and general FOSS for geospatial goodness. Please share the newsletter widely. Interested folks can [sign up](#) too. For now, please enjoy this edition.

News from OSGeo:UK

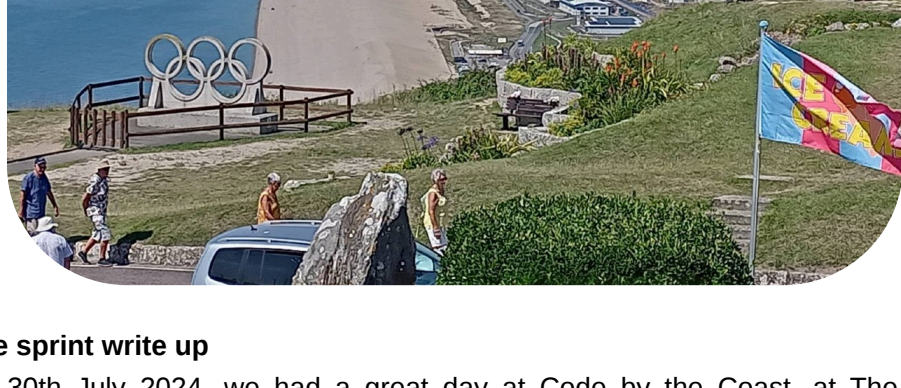
Find out more about OSGeo:UK and how you can be part of our community on our [website](#).

Upcoming event

There might not be a national FOSS4G:UK event this year but that hasn't stopped a bunch of us in the Bristol area organising [FOSS4G:UK South West 2024](#). This is going to be an event similar in scope to the local event that was held in the city last year as part of the distributed FOSS4G:UK, and will happen on 12th November 2024. If you like free and open source software, geospatial technologies and/or open data and communities then this is the event for you!

Our thanks to [CGI](#) for their generous sponsoring of the venue (the [Engine Shed](#) just outside Bristol Temple Meads station). There are still sponsorship opportunities available to help the event run at as low a cost as possible for attendees - if your organisation wants to help with sponsorship then please reach out to the organisers.

A call for papers and ticket sales will all be announced via the website, so keep an eye on it over the next few weeks.



UK code sprint write up

On Tue 30th July 2024, we had a great day at Code by the Coast, at The Heights, Portland, Dorset. OSGeo:UK's latest code sprint brought 18 people together to work on a number of FOSS4G projects, including [Terra Draw](#) and [GIFramework Maps](#).

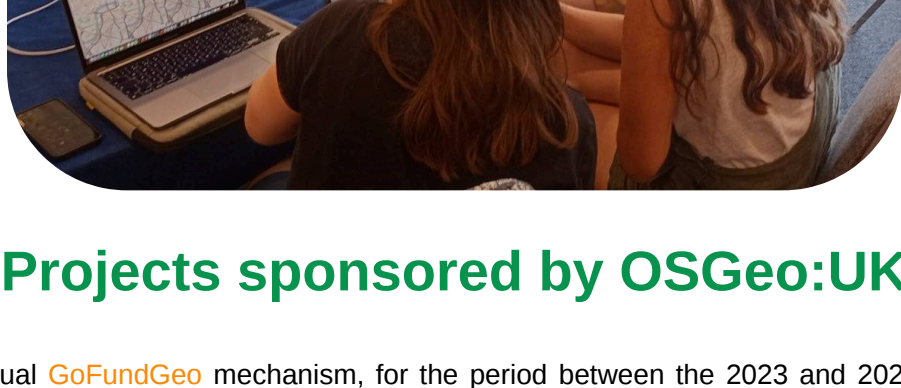
"The code sprint let us introduce GIFramework Maps to new developers and will help to start growing the community for the project. We looked at some important topics including getting the application to translate into other languages like Welsh. On behalf of the development team, we'd like to thank everyone that took time to work with us and look forward to working with you and others in the future." **GIFramework Maps Team**

"The code sprint was a great opportunity to get people familiarised with Terra Draw and improve the onboarding experience for new contributors to and users of the project. We had five pull requests in total, focusing on documentation and testing of the application. We also found a bug with the OpenLayers adapter which wouldn't have been uncovered and diagnosed without the help of the participants (it was a Windows only issue!)." **James Milner, Terra Draw**

We also progressed the registration of Terra Draw, GIFramework Maps and XYZ as OSGeo Community projects, and spent a bit of time looking at OGC API Standards including EDR ([Environmental Data Retrieval](#)) and the [Marine Tools](#) QGIS Plugin. For those that haven't come across it before, [XYZ](#) is an "open source JavaScript framework for spatial data and application interfaces".

Along with the great coding and networking, we also had some lovely views from an excellent venue. It was rather warm though, but The Heights rose to the challenge and provided us with iced coffee!

Many thanks to both [OSGeo:UK GoFundGeo](#) and [Addresscloud](#) for sponsoring the event, and for those participants who paid for their own tickets - we couldn't have done it without you!



Projects sponsored by OSGeo:UK

Our annual [GoFundGeo](#) mechanism, for the period between the 2023 and 2024 AGMs, distributed more than £5000 across seven projects (see the [OSGeo:UK website](#) for the full list).

Regina Obe, who we have sponsored in the past, will be presenting at FOSS4G NA (see below) about the work she does for the PostGIS project. Since sponsoring Regina directly this funding stream has shifted to [pgRouting](#) (which she works on) at Gold sponsorship level. [pgRouting](#) is a PostgreSQL/PostGIS extension for routing and network analysis.

If you are interested in [Terra Draw](#) you can follow recent developments on the [thread linked to here](#). Commits have also recently been made in the development of [gis2web](#) and the full details can be found [here](#).



Wider software and event news

Presentations from [FOSS4G Europe](#) (held in early July in Tartu, Estonia) are [now online](#). If you were unable to make the event in Estonia in July then grab a coffee and catch up when it suits you. Here are a couple of written reviews of the event: the [first is from a company called Speckle](#) that puts 3D data on the web (the review is from their company perspective), whilst the second is a [comprehensive review and thank-you from the Conference Chair](#), Tõnis Kärdi.

Remember, the [international FOSS4G 2024](#) event is being held between December 1-8, 2024 in [Belém](#), Brazil. Register to find out what is new and exciting in open software, data, and communities from around the world and keep an eye on their website for announcements and updates. There will be a [Geomob podcast](#) episode coming out in a couple of weeks where the hosts speak with the conference organisers about what is involved in putting together the global event.

If you find yourself in the USA in early September then you might want to detour to the [FOSS4G NA conference](#) being held on September 9th - 11th in St. Louis, Missouri. The [schedule is now out](#), and it looks like there are some amazing presentations planned. We look forward to seeing recordings online!

Other events

Talking of geospatial conferences, they may not be FOSS4G related but the [National Earth Observation Conference](#) and the [Association for Geographic Information GeoCom](#) are both happening later this year in the UK (10-12 September in York and 28 November in London, respectively) so you might want to check those out.



In wider geospatial FOSS news...

"The evolution of geospatial data processing has taken a significant step forward with the introduction of lightweight versions of the Geospatial Data Abstraction Library ([GDAL](#)) and the Point Data Abstraction Library ([PDAL](#))". So starts an [article](#) detailing the benefits and considerations behind creating and releasing lightweight versions of GDAL and PDAL. It's a fascinating read, and explains that the driver for the work was a bloated package on [conda-forge](#) which led to user frustration. Effectively what the development team has done is separate out the plugins for certain format support from the core package, making the plugins also available as conda packages. Dependencies are reduced, and build and install times are reduced. Win! For details on installation and which plugins have been developed so far, as well as benchmarking results then please do read through the original article.

[EO-Tools](#) is a set of Python tools that enable search, download and processing of Sentinel-1 and -2 data alongside certain DEM (Digital Elevation Models) datasets. If you are interested in SAR interferometry then the Package has now added functionality that allows you to rapidly [find and visualise InSAR image pairs](#). Check out the documentation for more details.

And finally, there are two project birthdays to celebrate. At the end of July [GRASS GIS celebrated its 41st birthday](#). OpenStreetMap was [20 years old](#) on the 9th August. "Happy Birthday!" and may the future years be as impacting as the past. Thank you to everyone who has helped make these projects what they are today.



We hope that you found this edition of the newsletter interesting and informative. If you have any feedback or comments then let us know!



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